

PUNJAB & RAJASTHAN ORIGIN

Missi Roti

Spiced Gram Flour & Wheat Bread

The Farmer's Hearty Flatbread

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Missi Roti

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Missi Roti

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Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Rustic Bread Built for a Long Day's Work

Missi roti belongs to the rural kitchens of Punjab and Rajasthan, where it has long been a farmer's bread — dense, protein-rich, and satisfying enough to sustain a full day of physical labor in the fields. Its name comes from the Hindi word "missi," meaning mixed, referring to the blend of besan (gram flour) folded into the usual whole wheat dough.

Unlike naan or plain roti, missi roti carries its own seasoning right in the dough — onions, green chilies, carom seeds, and warming spices are worked directly into the flour, so every bite delivers flavor without needing a curry alongside it. This made it especially practical for farmers who might eat it in the field with nothing more than a raw onion, a pat of white butter, or a bit of pickle.

Today it remains a beloved comfort food across Punjab and Rajasthan, often served at family meals alongside a bowl of curd or lassi, valued as much for its heartiness as for the nostalgia it carries for many North Indian households.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Rustic Bread Built for a Long Day's Work, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

A rustic, farmer's bread historically eaten in the fields with minimal accompaniment. A Rajasthani thali staple, often paired with curd, pickle, or a glass of chaas (buttermilk). Considered a more nutrient-dense alternative to plain roti, thanks to the protein and fiber in besan. Frequently made during winter months in Punjab, when a heartier, spiced bread is especially welcome.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

15m	20m	15m	4
ACTIVE PREP	DOUGH REST	COOK TIME	SERVINGS (6 ROTIS)

Easy
DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowl
- Rolling pin
- Heavy tava or cast-iron skillet
- Basting brush or spoon for ghee

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Dough is best used fresh, as the onion releases moisture over time, but can be refrigerated for a few hours if needed. Cooked missi roti keeps well at room temperature for a few hours or refrigerated for 2 days — reheat on a dry tava with a little extra ghee to restore softness.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dough

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Whole wheat flour (atta)	1½ cups	190 g	1½ katori
Besan (gram flour)	½ cup	60 g	½ katori
Onion, finely chopped	¼ cup	40 g	¼ katori
Green chili, finely chopped	1	1	1
Fresh coriander, chopped	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp
Carom seeds (ajwain)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Salt	¾ tsp	4.5 g	to taste
Oil (in the dough)	1 tbsp	15 ml	1 chammach
Water, as needed	½ cup approx.	120 ml approx.	½ katori approx.
Ghee, for cooking	2 tbsp	30 g	2 chammach

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Besan (gram flour, made from ground chickpeas) is widely available at Indian grocers and increasingly at general supermarkets in the gluten-free flour aisle. If green chilies aren't available, a pinch of cayenne or a small amount of jalapeño works as a substitute. White butter (makhan) is traditional for serving but any good quality unsalted butter is a fine substitute outside India.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Spiced Dough

01 COMBINE THE DRY INGREDIENTS

In a large bowl, mix the whole wheat flour, besan, carom seeds, red chili powder, and salt.

02 ADD THE AROMATICS

Mix in the chopped onion, green chili, coriander, and oil, distributing everything evenly through the flour.

03 KNEAD THE DOUGH

Gradually add water, mixing and kneading until you have a smooth, firm dough — slightly firmer than a plain roti dough, since the onion will release some moisture as it rests.

> **Chef tip.** add water a little at a time — the onion's moisture means you'll likely need less than you expect.

04 REST BRIEFLY

Cover and let the dough rest for 15–20 minutes to relax the gluten before rolling.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Spiced Dough, continued



COOKING CHECKPOINT

The dough should feel firm but pliable, holding together well without cracking at the edges when rolled.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Rolling & Cooking

05 DIVIDE AND ROLL

Divide into 6 balls. Roll each gently, using extra flour as needed since the onion pieces can make rolling slightly trickier than plain dough — aim for about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.

06 COOK ON THE TAVA

Heat a tava over medium heat. Place the rolled roti on the dry surface and cook for about a minute, until small bubbles appear.



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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Rolling & Cooking, continued

07 ADD GHEE AND FLIP

Flip and drizzle a little ghee around the edges. Cook both sides until golden-brown spots appear all over, pressing gently with a spatula to encourage even cooking.

Color indicator. missi roti should develop deep golden-brown spots, darker than a plain roti, since the besan browns more readily.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Cooking missi roti over too-high heat browns the outside before the inside fully cooks, since the dough is thicker than plain roti. Medium heat and a slightly longer cook time give the best results.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served with a generous dollop of white butter (makhan) melting on top.
- A classic Rajasthani pairing with plain curd or a glass of spiced chaas (buttermilk).

Restaurant Presentation

- Served in wedges with a trio of chutneys — mint, tamarind, and pickle.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- Served alongside a simple dal and pickle for a complete, humble weeknight meal.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Texture Right

- Don't over-knead — missi roti dough should stay slightly rustic and textured, not silky smooth.
- A generous amount of ghee while cooking is what gives it its signature golden, slightly crisp edges.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Pre-mix the dry spiced flour blend in bulk and store airtight, adding fresh onion and water only when ready to cook.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some cooks add a small spoon of yogurt to the dough for extra softness and a subtle tang that balances the besan's earthiness.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

165 kcal	5.5 g	23 g	6 g	4 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with fat used and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Punjabi Missi Roti	heavier on onion and ajwain, less spicy overall.
Rajasthani Missi Roti	often includes ground fennel and extra red chili for more heat.
Stuffed Missi Roti	a modern variation with a spiced potato filling folded in.

Can I make this gluten-free?

Not fully as written, since it relies on whole wheat flour for structure, but experimenting with a higher besan ratio and a gluten-free binder is possible for advanced bakers.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why is my dough cracking when I roll it?

Usually too little moisture or over-resting, which lets the dough dry out. Keep it covered and add a touch more water if needed.

Can I skip the onion?

Yes — a plain missi roti with just besan and spices is also traditional and slightly easier to roll.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Besan	gram flour, made from ground chickpeas, the defining ingredient of missi roti.
Ajwain	carom seeds, a small aromatic seed with a thyme-like flavor, common in North Indian breads.
Makhan	fresh, unsalted white butter, traditionally served with missi roti.
Chaas	spiced buttermilk, a classic cooling drink paired with this bread.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Missi Roti

15m ACTIVE PREP	**20m** DOUGH REST
15m COOK TIME	**4** SERVINGS (6 ROTIS)
Easy DIFFICULTY	

DOUGH

Whole wheat flour	190 g
Besan	60 g
Onion	40 g
Green chili	1
Fresh coriander	8 g
Carom seeds	1.5 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Salt	4.5 g
Oil	15 ml
Water	120 ml approx.
Ghee	30 g

METHOD

01 **Combine the dry ingredients.** In a large bowl, mix the whole wheat flour, besan, carom seeds, red chili powder, and salt.

02 **Add the aromatics.** Mix in the chopped onion, green chili, coriander, and oil, distributing everything evenly through the flour.

03 **Knead the dough.** Gradually add water, mixing and kneading until you have a smooth, firm dough — slightly firmer than a plain roti dough, since the onion will release some moisture as it rests.

04 **Rest briefly.** Cover and let the dough rest for 15–20 minutes to relax the gluten before rolling.

05 **Divide and roll.** Divide into 6 balls.

06 **Cook on the tava.** Heat a tava over medium heat.

07 **Add ghee and flip.** Flip and drizzle a little ghee around the edges.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Whole wheat flour	190 g	☐ Besan	60 g
☐ Onion	40 g	☐ Green chili	1
☐ Fresh coriander	8 g	☐ Carom seeds	1.5 g
☐ Red chili powder	1.5 g	☐ Salt	4.5 g
☐ Oil	15 ml	☐ Ghee	30 g

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